Ganga and from the Sharada also showed that there was no radioactive contamination in the water and soil.

Desai promised Parliament that a committee would be set up to examine the issue and subsequently, the Cabinet Secretariat appointed a panel headed by Atma Ram to examine the possibility of nuclear pollution of the Ganges by the spy device left atop Nanda Devi by the CIA. The Atma Ram Panel comprising Dr H.N. Sethna, Prof. M.G. K. Menon, Dr Raja Ramanna, Dr V. Ramalingaswami, Prof. A.K. Saha and Dr K. T. Thomas submitted its report in April 1979 and it was tabled in Parliament on 18 May 1979. The panel unanimously expressed the view that the hazards of radiation because of the release of plutonium from the device are 'negligibly small in magnitude and should not be a matter for alarm.'

What happened to the device at the Nanda peaks? The Atma Ram panel suggested that new techniques needed to be adopted to locate the device. 'The committee has also considered the possibility of the device being still intact but lying buried somewhere. It has pointed out that even in this case there is no hazard unless the device is disturbed or disintegrated.'

India and the USA also collaborated after an Indian airliner was hijacked and blown up at the Lahore airport by two Kashmiri militants on 2 February 1971. The aircraft was hijacked on 30 January 1971. Indian government officials held a meeting with the Americans on 4 February 1971 and they confirmed a representation had already been made to Pakistan. The hijackers were treated as heroes by the Pakistan government and this worried both India and the USA. The Indian agencies believed that the premeditated criminal act of hijacking and wanton destruction of the Indian Airlines aircraft within the